BRATISLAVA AND OTHER LOCATIONS, SLOVAKIA

Slovak National Gallery: Masterpieces

Selected landscapes and figures give ordinary activity a physical setting and an uneven pace.



The mower carries the tool that identifies his work, yet the painting catches him paused beside water. The miner rests his head in his hand. Elsewhere, wedding carriages and a playing child supply movement that these workers withhold. These differences give daily life several distinct tempos, each shaped by a particular activity or its interruption.

Light changes the pace as well. A dim lake requires the gradual separation of forms, while a morning courtyard divides itself into clear yellow and blue. Portraits and still lifes narrow the field further, letting a held apple, a flowering sprig or a change of fabric take on the organising role of a whole landscape.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/slovak-national-gallery

The selection · 20

1. Mower by a River
   László Mednyánszky · 1880–1885
2. Painter at the Front
   László Mednyánszky · 1914–1918
3. Evening Landscape by a Lake
   László Mednyánszky · 1885–1895
4. Old Košice
   Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik · c. 1915
5. In the Morning Sun: Village Courtyard
   Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik · c. 1910
6. Still Life with a Skull and a Forget-Me-Not
   František Klimkovič · c. 1860
7. Miner
   Géza Kukán · 1919–1925
8. Blooming Meadow with Trees
   Frida Konstantin · 1913
9. Poor Lunch
   Tivadar Zemplényi · 1886
10. The Conversion of Paul
    Árpád Feszty · 1900
11. Courtyard of the Old Town Hall in Bratislava
    Jindřich Tomec · 1923
12. Devín: Study for a Painting
    Jindřich Tomec · 1925
13. Girl with an Apple
    Ignác Roskovics · 1890–1900
14. Lady in a Satin Dress with a Pearl Necklace
    Ferdinand Karl Theodor Christoph Peter von Lütgendorff · 1834
15. Early Evening Landscape
    László Paál · 1870–1879
16. French Riviera
    János Vaszary · 1920
17. Girl with a Doll
    Josef Czauczik · 1830
18. The Tatra Mountains at Night
    Nándor Katona · c. 1900
19. The Peasant Wedding
    Jože Uprka · 1900–1910
20. Little Girl Playing
    Johann Baptist Reiter · 1851

01 / 20

Mower by a River

László Mednyánszky

1880–1885 · Slovak National Gallery



László Mednyánszky. Kosec pri rieke. Image credit: László Mednyánszky; Source credit: Web umenia. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The scythe names an occupation, but the man's narrow body is not shown completing a stroke. Mednyánszky gives the pause its own space within a dim landscape. The tall format makes the figure's slight lean consequential. Work remains present as equipment and bodily condition even when the moment contains no visible productivity.

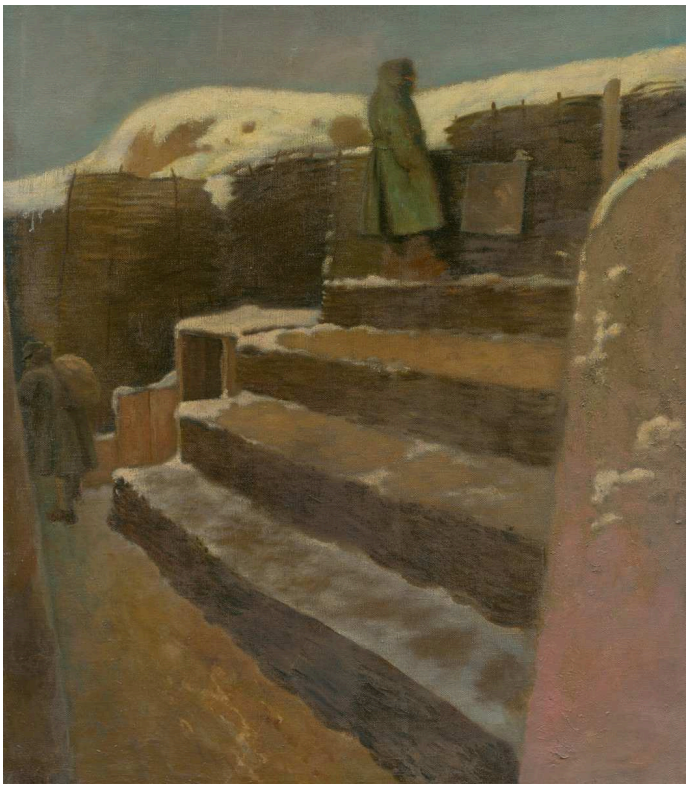
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 7146

02 / 20

Painter at the Front

László Mednyánszky

1914–1918 · Slovak National Gallery



László Mednyánszky. Frontový maliar. Image credit: László Mednyánszky; Source credit: Web umenia. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Rough steps and makeshift structures interrupt the approach to the figure. The low viewpoint does not permit an effortless survey. Mednyánszky places the painter among the awkward material conditions of wartime. The arrangement shows that obtaining a view is itself a physical act, dependent on where a body can stand and how it reaches that position.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 7145

03 / 20

Evening Landscape by a Lake

László Mednyánszky

1885–1895 · Slovak National Gallery



László Mednyánszky. Večerná krajina pri jazere. Image credit: László Mednyánszky; Source credit: Web umenia. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Water, trees and low ground separate only gradually in the near darkness. The small moon does not flood the scene with useful information. Mednyánszky lets close tonal differences establish the landscape's depth, making uncertainty of visibility part of the subject. Looking becomes a process of gathering limited evidence, with each newly distinguished form helping to place the others.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 7147

04 / 20

Old Košice

Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik

c. 1915 · Slovak National Gallery



Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik. Staré Košice. Image credit: Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_5320. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Broad roof shapes connect the clustered houses across the surface, while uneven outlines prevent them from becoming identical blocks. Kővári-Kačmarik makes the town feel compact without erasing individual structures. Brown and violet hold the buildings together beneath the blue opening of sky. The street's organisation emerges through colour as well as through architectural description.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5320

05 / 20

In the Morning Sun: Village Courtyard

Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik

c. 1910 · Slovak National Gallery



Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik. In the Morning Sun (Village Courtyard). Image credit: Konštantín Kővári-Kačmarik; Source credit: http://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_5179. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Yellow light and blue shadow divide the courtyard more strongly than small architectural details do. White houses provide surfaces on which that division can register. Kővári-Kačmarik makes a familiar place specific to a condition of light, with trees and rooflines preventing the bright boundary from becoming rigid. The hour reorganises what would otherwise be the same enclosure.

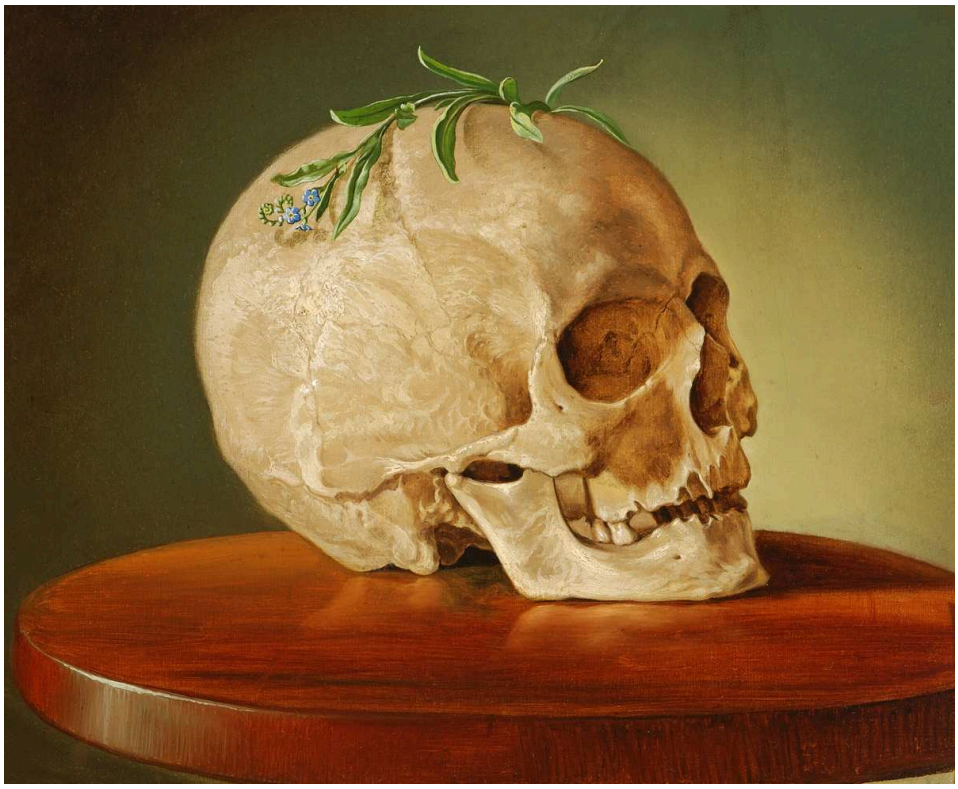
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5179

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Still Life with a Skull and a Forget-Me-Not

František Klimkovič

c. 1860 · Slovak National Gallery



František Klimkovič. Still Life with a Skull and a Forget-Me-Not. Image credit: František Klimkovič; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_775. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The flowering sprig is small beside the skull, but its placement across the crown gives it a direct relationship to the bone. Klimkovič keeps the arrangement spare enough for that contact to remain clear. The title encourages a reading of remembrance alongside mortality. Those ideas stay attached to specific objects instead of expanding into an elaborate scene of symbols.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 775

07 / 20

Miner

Géza Kukán

1919–1925 · Slovak National Gallery



Géza Kukán. Baník. Image credit: Géza Kukán; Source credit: Web umenia. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

One hand supports the seated man's head, giving rest a visible weight. Kukán keeps much of the room unresolved, allowing the dark red shirt and posture to establish the worker's presence. The title identifies an occupation without supplying a mining episode. The pause deserves attention as a bodily condition, not merely as time between more narratable actions.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3286

08 / 20

Blooming Meadow with Trees

Frida Konstantin

1913 · Slovak National Gallery



Frida Konstantin. Blooming Meadow with Trees. Image credit: Frida Konstantin; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_5085. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Short pale and pink touches repeatedly interrupt the green field. Frida Konstantin gathers the flowers into clusters, allowing many small marks to describe the meadow's growth together. It can appear as a pattern close to the eye and as extensive ground beneath the trees. These two readings remain available as attention moves across the painted surface.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5085

09 / 20

Poor Lunch

Tivadar Zemplényi

1886 · Slovak National Gallery



Tivadar Zemplényi. Poor Lunch. Image credit: Tivadar Zemplényi; Source credit: Web umenia. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The woman and child incline towards a modest exchange of food beside the white stove. Zemplényi keeps the room sparse, making the meal's scale consequential without turning the figures into distant examples of a condition. Their relationship remains an action between two people. The social subject is carried through a particular setting and shared need.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 780

10 / 20

The Conversion of Paul

Árpád Feszty

1900 · Slovak National Gallery



Árpád Feszty. Conversion of Paul. Image credit: Árpád Feszty; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_5725. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The fallen figure and nearby horse give the revelation a disrupted physical order. Intense yellow light distinguishes the central ground from bodies reacting in shadow. Feszty makes the religious event change the conditions of standing and seeing. Lost balance and unequal visibility carry the transformation through the whole scene, involving the surrounding figures in its disturbance.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5725

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Courtyard of the Old Town Hall in Bratislava

Jindřich Tomec

1923 · Slovak National Gallery



Jindřich Tomec. Courtyard of Old Town Hall in Bratislava. Image credit: Jindřich Tomec; Source credit: http://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.K_936. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The paved foreground offers room to stand before the repeated arches and rising tower. Small birds give that open area modest interruptions without competing with the building. Tomec joins a pedestrian enclosure to a much taller architectural scale. The courtyard reveals the civic structure from within, where its height can be measured against a sheltered space at ground level.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: K 936

12 / 20

Devín: Study for a Painting

Jindřich Tomec

1925 · Slovak National Gallery



Jindřich Tomec. Devín - štúdia k obrazu. Image credit: Jindřich Tomec; Web umenia. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Jind%C5%99ich_Tomec_-_Dev%C3%ADn_-_%C5%A1t%C3%BAdia_k_obrazu_-_O_1524_-_Slovak_National_Gallery.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The ruined walls grow out of a rocky promontory beside the river. Tomec's open handling lets masonry, terrain and atmosphere remain connected without giving each an equal finish. The study records an arrangement still being developed, with differences in finish directing attention through the view. The historical structure acquires its position from the land that supports it.

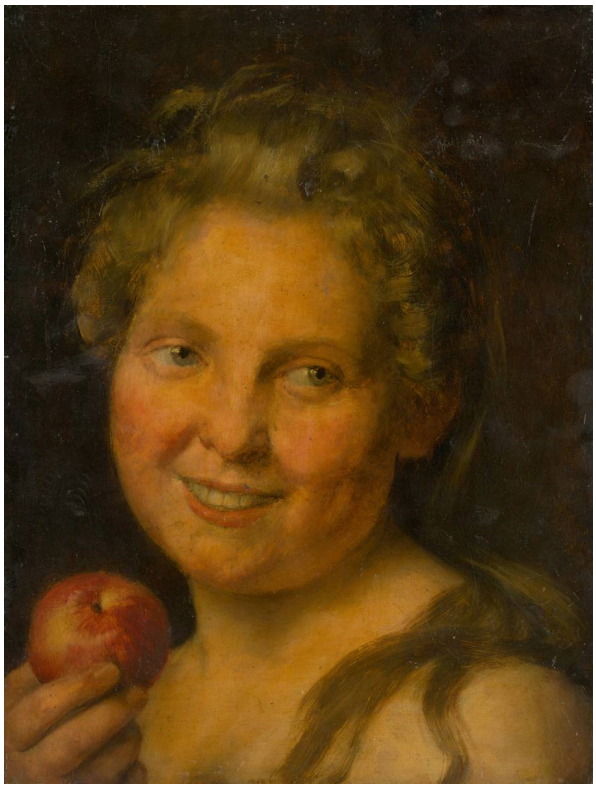
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 1524

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Girl with an Apple

Ignác Roskovics

1890–1900 · Slovak National Gallery



Ignác Roskovics. Dievča s jablkom. Image credit: Ignác Roskovics; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_3106. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The red apple near the shoulder brings hand and face into one close arrangement. Roskovics lets the smiling expression and lit hair establish an encounter against a dark ground. The object gives the pose something to do without requiring a larger domestic scene. Its immediate compositional role is already useful before any symbolic meaning is proposed.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 3106

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Lady in a Satin Dress with a Pearl Necklace

Ferdinand Karl Theodor Christoph Peter von Lütgendorff

1834 · Slovak National Gallery



Ferdinand Karl Theodor Christoph Peter von Lütgendorff. Dáma v atlasových šatách s perlovým náhrdelníkom. Image credit: Ferdinand Karl Theodor Christoph Peter von Lütgendorff; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_5140. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Satin, pale scarf and small necklace answer the light differently. Lütgendorff makes those distinctions part of a formal social appearance, while the restrained pose leaves attention free to pass between the face and the fabrics. Their differing surfaces give the portrait its measured variety. The careful clothing identifies a mode of presentation without disclosing a complete personal character.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 5140

15 / 20

Early Evening Landscape

László Paál

1870–1879 · Slovak National Gallery



László Paál. Early Evening Landscape. Image credit: László Paál; http://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_2918. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:L%C3%A1szl%C3%B3_Pa%C3%A1l_-_Early_Evening_Landscape_-_O_2918_-_Slovak_National_Gallery.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The warm strip of sky supplies the clearest division as fence and vegetation gather into darker masses. Paál lets fading light simplify the view without making it empty. A seated figure measures the near ground, remaining subordinate to the broader change in visibility. Evening is represented through what can still be distinguished and what is beginning to merge.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 2918

16 / 20

French Riviera

János Vaszary

1920 · Slovak National Gallery



János Vaszary. French Riviera. Image credit: János Vaszary; Source credit: http://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_4091. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The car and terrace furniture belong to the scene as readily as foliage and blue water. Vaszary treats leisure as an arrangement of modern objects and occupied places, rendered with quick strokes and exposed light ground. The eye can move from one encounter to the next through the open handling, without a single incident commanding the whole view.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 4091

17 / 20

Girl with a Doll

Josef Czauczik

1830 · Slovak National Gallery



Josef Czauczik. Girl with a Doll. Image credit: Josef Czauczik; http://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_6985. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Jozef_Czauczik_-_Girl_with_a_Doll_-_O_6985_-_Slovak_National_Gallery.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The doll introduces the child's scale of play within a composed pose and carefully presented pale dress. Czauczik brings childhood into conventions that ask a sitter to remain available for inspection. The toy helps distinguish the subject from an adult without turning the portrait into a scene of active play. Compare the less settled body in Reiter's picture below.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 6985

18 / 20

The Tatra Mountains at Night

Nándor Katona

c. 1900 · Slovak National Gallery



Nándor Katona. The Tatra Mountain in the Night. Image credit: Nándor Katona; Source credit: https://www.webumenia.sk/dielo/SVK:SNG.O_6052. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The pale summit is more legible than the lower slopes and small foreground roof. Katona makes height register through unequal illumination, concentrating visibility near the top of the painting. Cloud and shadow interrupt the surrounding ridges, leaving the peak with a selective clarity. The inhabited ground remains present, but almost disappears beneath the mountain's larger scale.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 6052

19 / 20

The Peasant Wedding

Jože Uprka

1900–1910 · Slovak National Gallery



Jože Uprka. The Peasant Wedding. Image credit: Jože Uprka; Web umenia. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Jo%C5%BEa_%C3%9Aprka_-_Sedliacka_svatba_-_O_884_-_Slovak_National_Gallery.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Horses and carriages carry the celebration through a dense crowd, while red cloth and repeated costumes create visible intervals in its movement. Uprka represents a social event that exceeds any one participant. Individuals remain distinguishable, but the procession supplies the larger organisation. The continuation towards the edges prevents the group from becoming a neatly closed ceremonial portrait.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 884

20 / 20

Little Girl Playing

Johann Baptist Reiter

1851 · Slovak National Gallery



Johann Baptist Reiter. Hrajúce sa dievčatko. Image credit: Johann Baptist Reiter; Web umenia. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Johann_Baptist_Reiter_-_Hraj%C3%BAce_sa_diev%C4%8Datko_-_O_1181_-_Slovak_National_Gallery.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The raised arm and leaning body refuse the settled posture of a formal child portrait. Reiter gives the colourful objects an immediate relationship to an action still under way. Dark drapery encloses the space while pale clothing makes the unstable pose easy to follow. Play becomes something the child is doing rather than an attribute held still for recognition.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: O 1181

Compare a task with a pause

The scythe, supported head and raised playing hand describe different uses of a body. Returning to them after the landscapes can make their settings more consequential. This is a selection from recorded holdings; consult the Slovak National Gallery's current venue and display information rather than assuming every work shares one exhibition space.

Further reading

The Elements of Drawing

John Ruskin · Read free · English

Ruskin’s exercises begin with close attention to edges, tones and natural forms. They can be tried beside the trees, rocks and village views here, while remembering that these painters made different choices about finish and simplification.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

Artline · Slovak National Gallery: Masterpieces